

PRIME MINISTER



RAHUL GANDHI



NARENDRA MODI

& OTHERS

MAYAWATI	5
MULAYAM SINGH	4
LALU PRASAD	4
M. KARUNANIDHI	1
NITISH KUMAR	1
SHARAD PAWAR	1
PRANAB MUKHERJEE	1

Don't know/can't say: 9; (All figures in per cent)

Atal Bihari Vajpayee has remained out of the public eye but not out of the mind as he still remains the third-most preferred prime minister. For the first time, Manmohan Singh topped Sonia Gandhi while Rahul Gandhi's forays into the hinterlands are paying dividends as he is propelled into fifth place.

Between the two of them, do you think Manmohan Singh is more powerful than Sonia Gandhi?

**Manmohan
Singh
24**

**Sonia
Gandhi
69**

Don't know/can't say: 7 (All figures in per cent)

The perception that the UPA chairperson is the power behind Manmohan's throne persists into the fifth year.

sisting of the Third Front and "others" whose size and shape are altered each time there is even a minor tremor in the two major combines. This group which discovers a sense of bonding every time elections are announced has significantly improved its tally, taking it to between 169 and 178 seats, up from the 125 seats it actually won in 2004, virtually clicking on the heels of the NDA.

This a drastic change from the situation existing just two years ago. The INDIA TODAY ORG-MARG Mood of the Nation polls in January 2007 had projected massive gains for the UPA with a 40.2 per cent vote share and as many as 270 seats. Not since the Vajpayee-led NDA registered a 41.7 per cent vote and won 304 seats in the 1999 Lok Sabha polls has a party or combine ever crossed the 38 per cent vote-share. The